01 | STAFF TOOLS

Make direction clear.

CLEAR Communication Elements (CCEs)

Six questions help everyone understand the work, the reason, and the next step.

01	**What is changing or being asked** Who must do what, and by when?
02	**Why / Why it is changing** Explain the reason the work or change is needed.
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Name the person doing the work and the person who may decide.
04	**What is not changing** State which duties, rules, deadlines, or approvals stay in place.
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Name the contact route and when to expect a reply or update.
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** Point to the correct form, policy, guide, or other source when one applies.

For all staff

Use these questions to understand direction and identify missing information. Leaders use CCEs 1–5 in covered written direction and include CCE 6 whenever a source applies.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | AT YOUR DESK

CCEs: check the message

Use when writing, reading, or passing along work direction.

> **When the directive applies**
> Leadership written expectations, changes, decisions, and work reminders use CCEs 1–5. Include CCE 6 whenever applicable. Greetings and receipt-only replies do not require the template.

Element	Check for a usable answer
1. What is changing or being asked	Who must do what, and by when?
2. Why / Why it is changing	Explain the reason the work or change is needed.
3. Who owns it and who decides	Name the person doing the work and the person who may decide.
4. What is not changing	State which duties, rules, deadlines, or approvals stay in place.
5. What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back	Name the contact route and when to expect a reply or update.
6. Where this lives (whenever applicable)	Point to the correct form, policy, guide, or other source when one applies.

Before sending or passing it along

Keep the approved action, reason, deadline, audience, and decision authority intact. Use clearer words without changing the direction. Confirm missing facts instead of filling gaps with a guess.

When you are receiving direction

> *"I understand that I need to _____ by _____. I am responsible for _____. I still need to confirm _____ with _____."*

> **One final check**
> Could the reader explain the next action, timing, and route for help? A link supports a clear message; it does not replace one.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Clear messages, shared understanding

Use the CCEs to make direction usable at every level.

The approved CCE Administrative Directive applies to leadership written direction. All staff can use the same questions to understand an assignment, ask for a missing detail, or check a handoff. The tool does not add approval authority.

What to include

01	**What is changing or being asked** Name the audience, the action, and its deadline or start date. Separate a date for sharing information from a date for doing the work.
02	**Why / Why it is changing** Give the purpose or problem being addressed. “Because management asked” does not explain why the work matters.
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Separate the work owner from the decision owner. Identify what the reader may decide and what needs another authorized person.
04	**What is not changing** Name the duties, service expectations, rules, or approval routes that remain. Do not call an unconfirmed detail “unchanged.”
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Name who receives questions and the response expectation. For escalated questions, give an answer or a named owner within two working days and a next update when needed.
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** When a supporting source exists, identify the current document, version, and verified location. When none applies, do not invent a source.

> **Use by content, not by channel**
> A short email, chat message, forward, or reminder still needs the applicable CCEs when it gives covered direction. A greeting or a reply that only confirms receipt does not.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

A complete message example

Illustrative example only. Replace the facts with your actual direction.

CCE	Example wording
1. Action	Service desk staff: check next week's proposed coverage and email conflicts to your supervisor by Thursday at noon.
2. Reason	We need to identify coverage gaps before the schedule is confirmed.
3. Owners	Staff check their availability. In this example, the supervisor holds confirmed authority to approve the unit's coverage plan.
4. Unchanged	Current assignments, service hours, leave approvals, and duties remain until an authorized change is confirmed.
5. Questions and reply	Send questions to your supervisor. Escalated questions receive an answer or named owner within two working days, with a next update if more time is needed.
6. Source	Use the current coverage schedule attached to the message. In actual work, include the approved attachment or verified location.

Build your next message

Use this space	Your notes
Action and timing	
Reason and owners	
What stays the same	
Question route and source	

Check understanding without blame

Ask: "To check that I explained this clearly, what will you do next?" Listen for the action, timing, and contact for help. Fix the message when the answer reveals a gap.

Keep the meaning intact: clearer words must not change a confirmed action, deadline, or decision owner.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

02 | DECISION ESCALATION

Check the facts before you act.

The Ladder of Inference

We can move from an observation to a judgment quickly. Pause before treating your interpretation as a fact.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

> **Walk back down the ladder**
> What do I know? What am I adding? What question would test my assumption? Check the answer before deciding or escalating.

The feedback loop: what we believe can influence which details we notice next.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

02 | AT YOUR DESK

From observation to action

Use the full ladder to test your thinking before a decision or request.

Rung	What to check
1. Observe facts	What was actually said, done, or recorded?
2. Select information	Which details did I notice or leave out?
3. Add meaning	How am I interpreting those details?
4. Make assumptions	What am I treating as true without checking?
5. Draw conclusions	What judgment am I reaching?
6. Form beliefs	What am I now accepting as true?
7. Take action	How will I respond?

Separate the fact from the story

Known fact	Possible assumption	Useful question
"Please send your recommendation" was the reply.	"They already know the answer and are wasting my time."	"Which decision, facts, and boundaries should my recommendation address?"

Use before deciding or escalating

State the exact decision. Check the current source and who holds the authority. Ask the question that resolves the missing fact. Update your conclusion when new information changes it.

Fact I can verify: _____

Assumption to check: _____

Question and next step: _____

> **A pause is not a delay in required action**
> Use the required urgent route when a safety concern or immediate service risk needs action. Do not wait to complete a worksheet.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

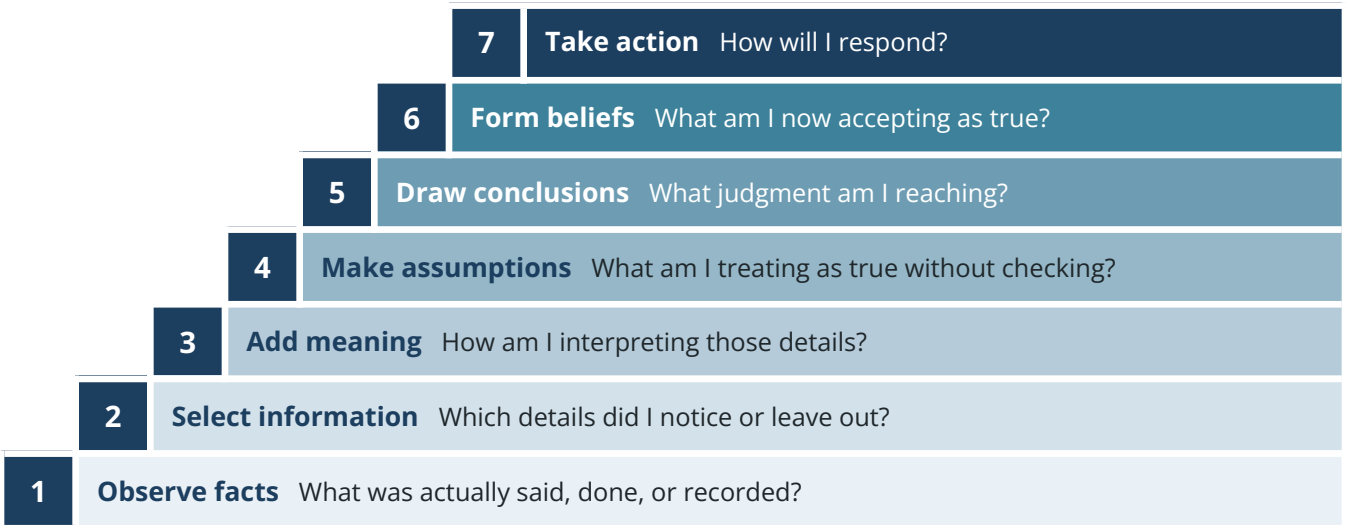
Learn more: Watch the TED-Ed lesson

02 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

How the ladder shapes a decision

The full seven-rung model, applied to everyday DSS work.

The Ladder of Inference describes the path from what we observe to how we act. The steps can happen quickly. The model helps us notice where an interpretation has become an assumption.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

The feedback loop

Our beliefs influence what we notice next. Believing that someone never responds may make a delay stand out while we overlook their earlier reply. Look for evidence that challenges your first explanation.

> **Use the model to check yourself, not label someone else**
> Describe the words or actions you observed. Ask a neutral question. Listen for information that changes your view. A conclusion can be reasonable and still need verification.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

Learn more: TED-Ed lesson | USC explanation of the seven steps

02 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Turn an assumption into a useful question

Illustrative workplace example. This is not a report of an actual County incident.

Part of the ladder	What might happen
1–2. Facts and selection	A supervisor replies, "Please send your recommendation." You focus on the request but may not know what information the supervisor still needs.
3–4. Meaning and assumptions	You interpret the reply as a brush-off and assume the decision has already been made. Neither point was stated.
5–7. Conclusion, belief, action	You conclude your input will not matter, believe the process is pointless, and delay the request or send a frustrated response.

A better next step

> **Ask a question that can change the decision**
> "I can prepare a recommendation. Which decision needs to be made, what facts should I include, and when is the recommendation needed?"

Then confirm your responsibility and authority. You may own the research or recommendation while someone else owns approval. Share the verified facts, the unresolved question, and your recommended next action.

Use this with a current situation

Use this space	Your notes
What I observed	
Assumption / other explanation	
Question / person to ask	
What I will do next	

Notice when your view changes

> *"I first thought _____. After checking _____, I learned _____. My next step is _____."*

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

03 | TIME MANAGEMENT

Urgent is not the same as important.

Use the Eisenhower Chart to choose your next action.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Address a real service risk or deadline now. Use the correct authority.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Protect time for prevention, planning, learning, and required work before it becomes urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Verify the demand. Route, delegate, or renegotiate only within your authority.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Reduce work with no useful purpose after checking that it is not required.

Protect important work before it becomes a crisis
Choose one Q2 task. Put it on your calendar. Name what finished looks like.

Two questions to ask

Urgent: What happens if this waits?

Important: How does this support required duties, service, safety, or agreed goals?

Your role, branch RACI, job expectations, and supervisor's direction help define importance. Required work is not optional because it feels routine.

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.

03 | AT YOUR DESK

Sort the work. Choose the next step.

Check the actual deadline, the impact of waiting, and your role.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Address a real service risk or deadline now. Use the correct authority.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Protect time for prevention, planning, learning, and required work before it becomes urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Verify the demand. Route, delegate, or renegotiate only within your authority.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Reduce work with no useful purpose after checking that it is not required.

Check urgency: Verify the deadline and the effect of waiting.

Check importance: Connect the task to required work, service, safety, or agreed goals.

Check authority: Confirm who may change the timing, assign the work, or stop it.

Protect a Q2 task today

Use this space	Your notes
Task and finish point	
Protected time / owner	

When priorities conflict

Bring the deadlines, impacts, two workable options, and your recommendation to the authorized leader. Confirm which work comes first; do not drop a required duty on your own.

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey: importance and urgency

03 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Choose priorities with purpose

Use the chart with your actual responsibilities and decision authority.

Urgency is about time and the effect of delay. Importance is about the result: required work, service, safety, and agreed goals. A request can feel urgent without being the best use of your time.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Address a real service risk or deadline now. Use the correct authority.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Protect time for prevention, planning, learning, and required work before it becomes urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Verify the demand. Route, delegate, or renegotiate only within your authority.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Reduce work with no useful purpose after checking that it is not required.

Define importance through your role

Start with your job responsibilities, the branch RACI, current procedures, and expectations set by your supervisor. The seniority of the requester does not replace checking the actual service need or deadline.

Use Office Hours and protected work time

Bring nonurgent questions to the published support or Office Hours schedule when appropriate. Use protected focus time to complete important work, process requests, and send replies. Urgent service or safety issues use the required route without waiting for Office Hours.

> **Avoid these two shortcuts**
> Q3 does not mean hand every urgent task to someone else. Q4 does not mean delete a required duty. Check the need and your authority before changing or stopping work.

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey model context

03 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Move from a chart to a plan

Illustrative examples. Your actual facts and role may change the quadrant.

Example	Quadrant	Useful next action
Coverage is missing before the next required service window.	Q1	Act through the correct route to address the immediate service risk.
Repeated confusion could be prevented with a clearer job aid.	Q2	Schedule time to prepare the update and obtain any required review.
An optional font change is requested by noon; it does not affect the work.	Q3	Verify the deadline and purpose. Renegotiate or route it within authority.
An optional flyer for a canceled event is still being polished.	Q4	Confirm there is no remaining requirement, then stop or reduce the work.

Plan one important task

Use this space	Your notes
Task and reason	
Deadline / protected time	
Quadrant / action / owner	
What finished looks like	

Review the result

Did the protected time happen? What interrupted it? Did the task prevent repeat questions, reduce rework, or improve service? Adjust the plan without losing the purpose of the work.

Make the next step visible

"I will complete _____ during _____. The result will be _____. I need _____ confirmed by _____."

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.

04 | ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Know who does what.

RACI Chart • Seven tasks • One clear owner for each outcome

R Responsible
Does the work.

A Accountable
Owns the outcome. One A per row.

C Consulted
Gives needed input before action.

I Informed
Receives the needed update.

Write a specific task or decision in each row. Add the names or roles for R, A, C, and I.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Confirm the chart with the right people

Every row needs an R and one A. The same person may be both. Mark missing assignments "To confirm" and check them through the current approval route.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow current approved branch guidance.

04 | AT YOUR DESK

Blank RACI chart

Write names or roles in the columns. Use a separate row when the decision owner changes.

R does the work. **A** owns the outcome. **C** gives input before action. **I** receives updates.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Confirm before using

Each task has an R and one A. A/R may be the same person. Consulted and informed roles match the need. The assignments agree with current authority, required review, and approved procedures.

Source / boundaries: _____

Questions to confirm: _____

> **A chart records responsibility**
> Completing this chart does not grant approval authority or replace the approved branch RACI or Decision & Permission Matrix.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow current approved branch guidance.

04 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Clarify the work and its owners

Use the blank seven-task chart on page 2 with your team.

A RACI chart makes responsibilities visible. It separates the person doing the work from the person accountable for the outcome, and identifies who needs to contribute or receive updates.

Role	What it means	Question to ask
R • Responsible	Completes the task or carries out the agreed work.	Who is doing this?
A • Accountable	Owns the outcome and the relevant decision. Use one A per row.	Who answers for the result?
C • Consulted	Provides needed information before a decision or action.	Whose input is required?
I • Informed	Receives the update needed to understand or act on the result.	Who needs to know?

Build the chart together

01 **Name one task or decision**
List one action per row. Split preparation, approval, and implementation when different people own them.

02 **Identify R and one A**
Check the current authority. Name an R and one A. The same person may hold both roles.

03 **Add C and I**
Name the people whose input is required and those who need the result. Consultation does not transfer ownership.

04 **Confirm and maintain**
Review with those involved and the authorized leader. Record the source, open questions, and review date.

> **When ownership is unclear**
> Mark the entry "To confirm." Name who will obtain the answer. Continue only the work already within your authority while that question is resolved.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Definition support: Cornell IT. **Learn more:** Cornell IT definitions

04 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Seven-task RACI worksheet

Enter actual names or roles. Keep the task rows blank until your team completes them.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

R does the work. **A** owns the outcome. **C** gives input before action. **I** receives updates.

Use this space	Your notes
Source and version	
Scope / decision boundaries	
Open question and owner	

Confirmed with: _____ **Next review:** _____

Final check

One specific task or decision per row. At least one R and exactly one A when confirmed. Use the current approval route for any unresolved authority question.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, final Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow current approved branch guidance.

05 | SAFE TO DECIDE

Change direction. Preserve trust.

Five steps to a respectful reversal

01	**Recognize** Name the decision and the facts available at the time.
02	**Explain** State the new information, risk, or decision boundary that requires a change.
03	**Own** Take responsibility for the change in direction and for explaining it clearly.
04	**Direct** Give the next step, when it takes effect, and the support available.
05	**Clarify** Explain whether this changes one situation or a wider rule.

> **Change the decision, not the person's standing**
> Explain what changed and what happens next. Do not blame someone for following the direction they were given.

Receiving a reversal?

Ask what changes, why, when, and for whom. Confirm your next step, the support available, and which responsibilities remain yours.

Training basis: Safe to Decide, final Supervisor edition, slides 23–25. Five-step sequence retained.

05 | AT YOUR DESK

Five steps for a respectful reversal

Use when you are authorized to change a decision or are explaining a confirmed change.

Step	What to include	A useful phrase
1. Recognize	The original decision and information available.	"You used the information we had at the time."
2. Explain	The new fact, risk, or boundary.	"We now know _____, so _____ must change."
3. Own	Your responsibility for clear direction and follow-through.	"I am responsible for making this change clear."
4. Direct	The next action, timing, and support.	"The next step is _____. You will have _____."
5. Clarify	Whether one situation or a wider rule changes.	"This applies to _____. What remains unchanged is _____."

Before the conversation

Verify the facts and your authority. Identify the next action and support. Describe a decision as reasonable or authorized only when the facts support that description.

When you receive changed direction

> *"To confirm, I will now _____ by _____. I still own _____. This change applies to _____. I will contact _____ for support."*

> **When the change goes out in writing**
> Use the applicable CCEs. Preserve the confirmed decision, explain the reason, and make the next step clear to anyone affected.

Training basis: Safe to Decide, final Supervisor edition, slides 23–25. Five-step sequence retained.

05 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Correct the work without blame

A respectful reversal explains a change while keeping responsibility clear.

New facts can require a decision to change. The conversation should help people understand the reason and continue their work with confidence. Use this sequence when changing direction within your authority or explaining an authorized change.

01	**Recognize** State the original decision and the information available. Acknowledge the person's actual reasoning. Verify the facts before saying the decision was authorized or reasonable.
02	**Explain** Name the new information, service risk, or decision boundary that requires a change. Keep the explanation about the work, not the person's character.
03	**Own** Take responsibility for your role in the prior instruction and the new direction. Avoid shifting blame to staff or passing along an unexplained reversal.
04	**Direct** Say what happens next, when, who does it, and what support is available. Identify any decision that still needs an authorized person.
05	**Clarify** Say whether the change applies to this situation only or to a wider process. Do not present a one-time adjustment as a new rule.

Receiving the change is also active work

Ask about any missing step. Explain back what you will do, what remains yours to decide, and who will support the work. Share the confirmed change with affected people without adding blame or changing its meaning.

> **Respect and accountability can work together**
> A respectful explanation does not skip a necessary review. It keeps the facts, expectations, support, and ownership clear while the work is corrected.

Training basis: Safe to Decide, final Supervisor edition, slides 23–25. Five-step sequence retained.

05 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

A respectful reversal in practice

Illustrative example: a confirmed coverage need requires an authorized one-day adjustment.

Step	Example wording
1. Recognize	"You planned today's work using the coverage schedule we confirmed."
2. Explain	"We now have a coverage gap during the afternoon service window, so we need to adjust today's assignments."
3. Own	"I am responsible for making the updated direction clear and helping the team carry it out."
4. Direct	"Use the revised assignment for this afternoon. I will help notify the team and confirm support before the service window starts."
5. Clarify	"This adjustment applies today. Tomorrow's schedule and the usual approval process remain unchanged."

Plan your conversation

Use this space	Your notes
Decision and original facts	
New information / reason	
My responsibility	
Next action and support	
One situation or wider rule?	

Check that the message landed

Ask: "What will you do next, and what support do you still need?" Then confirm who will update anyone affected and whether a written CCE message or source update is required.

Training basis: Safe to Decide, final Supervisor edition, slides 23–25. Five-step sequence retained.

06 | DECISION ESCALATION & FOLLOW-THROUGH

Make the request easy to answer.

Six steps for a clear request

01	**Name the exact decision** Say what answer, approval, or clarification is needed.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Use the current source to identify what you own and what needs another person.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Separate verified facts from assumptions. Include the input needed for the decision.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Give workable choices and explain the option you recommend.
05	**Use the correct route and verify timing** Confirm the decision owner, the actual deadline, and the expected reply or next update.
06	**Track the reply and close the loop** Record the response, confirm the next action, and update those affected.

Prepare the request. Plan the follow-through.
Before sending, decide how you will track the reply. After sending, confirm the response and the next action. No reply does not mean approval.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41.

06 | AT YOUR DESK

Six steps for a clear request

Use for a decision request, escalation, or follow-up on an unresolved item.

Step	Check before sending
1. Name the exact decision	Can the reader tell what answer, approval, or clarification I need?
2. Check authority and boundaries	What can I decide or continue? What needs another authorized person?
3. Gather facts and required input	What do I know? What remains unconfirmed? Whose input is required?
4. Offer options and a recommendation	What are the workable choices? What do I recommend, and why?
5. Use the correct route and verify timing	Who owns the decision? What deadline is real? What reply or next update is confirmed?
6. Track the reply and close the loop	Who will track the request, carry out the next action, and update others?

Verify three different times

Decision needed by: _____ **Expected reply by:** _____

Next update, if unresolved: _____ **Confirmed with:** _____

For a follow-up request

Use the original request and agreed update date. State what remains unanswered, any new facts, and the effect of waiting. Check for an existing reply before sending a duplicate.

> **Routine response and urgent needs**
> Escalated questions receive an answer or a named response owner within two working days. More time requires a next update. Immediate risks and required deadlines use the proper urgent route.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41. Follow-up prompts are an application of the sequence.

06 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Escalate a decision, not the whole problem

Keep ownership of your next step while the right person decides.

01	**Name the exact decision** Be specific: "Which coverage option is approved?" is clearer than "Please handle this problem." State the answer, approval, or clarification you need.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Read the current role guidance, branch RACI, and Decision & Permission Matrix. Separate work you own from a decision held elsewhere.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Use the current source and verified facts. Name missing information. Get required consultation without presenting an assumption as evidence.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Give two practical options when available. Explain service impact, resources, and tradeoffs. If only one option is viable, explain why.
05	**Use the correct route and verify timing** Confirm who decides, when the decision is needed, the expected reply, and the next update. Distinguish a requested date from a confirmed commitment.
06	**Track the reply and close the loop** Before sending, plan who will follow up. After sending, record the response, confirm the next action and owner, and update those affected.

> **Do not confuse response with resolution**
> The two-working-day expectation is an answer or a named response owner, not a promise that every issue will be resolved. Verify the next update if more time is needed. Urgent required routes do not wait.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41.

06 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Prepare the request and the follow-up

Use actual facts, approved sources, and confirmed timing.

Part	Write your request
Decision needed	
Authority and source	
Facts / required input	
Options / recommendation	
Route / verified timing	
Tracker / next action	

Example request

A specific decision with a useful timing check

"We need approval for one of two coverage options. The attached summary shows the gap, each option, and required input. I recommend option A because it keeps the service window covered. The decision is needed before that window starts. Please confirm the decision owner and when we can expect an answer or next update. I will track the reply and notify the affected team."

Illustrative example only.

When following up on an unanswered request

> *"I am following up on the request sent on _____. The agreed update was _____. The unresolved decision is _____. New information is _____. Waiting affects _____. Please confirm the answer, response owner, or next update."*

Close the loop

Record the decision and any boundaries. Confirm who does what and by when. Share the relevant update with affected people. Continue only work already within your authority while approval is pending.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41. Examples and writing prompts are staff applications.